

Scoring — Faan

Most tables have a **3-faan** minimum to win, with an upper limit of **13 faan**. Faan do not stack with their constituents. Use this guide as a learning aid, not a referee. House rules vary.

Bonus & Situational

Self-Draw – draw the winning tile from the wall	1
Concealed – no claimed discards except the winning tile	1
Win on Last Tile – win on the last tile of the wall	1
Win by Kong – win on a replacement tile after a kong	1
Robbing the Kong – win on a tile used to form a kong	1
Win by Double Kong – win on a tile from a kong, which itself was from a kong	8
Heavenly Hand – dealer wins on their initial 14-tile hand	Limit
Earthly Hand – win on dealer's first discard	Limit

Flowers & Seasons

No Flowers – no flower or season tiles	1
Seat Flower – flower matching your seat	1
Seat Season – season matching your seat	1
Four Flowers – stacks with seat flower	2
Four Seasons – stacks with seat season	2
Seven Robbing One – seven flowers and seasons; can rob the remaining tile from another player when drawn; auto-win	5
Eight Immortals Crossing Sea – eight flowers and seasons; auto-win	Limit

Honors

Dragons – dragon triplet or quad	1 each
Seat Wind – wind triplet or quad	1
Round Wind – wind triplet or quad	1

All Hand Patterns

Chicken Hand	0 faan
<i>Mixed suits, sequences, and triplets</i>	
	

Setting Up & Basic Play

The Objective

Be the first to complete **four melds and one pair** (14 tiles), drawing from the wall or claiming discards. The minimum hand value to win is 3 faan.

The Tiles

Characters

Circles

Bamboos

Honors

Flowers & Seasons

一萬二萬三萬四萬五萬六萬七萬八萬九萬

東南西北發中

1. Build the Walls

Shuffle all 144 tiles face down. Builds four walls of **18 tiles long and 2 tiles high** (36 tiles each). Then push the walls closer together into a square.

2. Roll the Dice for the Break

The dealer (East) rolls three dice. Sums the total and go counter-clockwise that many times around the walls starting with East as 1 to determine which wall to break. Then count the same dice total from that wall going clockwise to make the break.

Seat	Dice totals wall			
East	5	9	13	17
South	6	10	14	18
West	3	7	11	15
North	4	8	12	16

3. Deal the Tiles

Deal tiles in groups of four going counter-clockwise, while drawing clockwise until everyone has **13 tiles** and the dealer has **14 tiles**. Everyone draws replacement tiles from the end of the wall for revealing bonus tiles, starting with the dealer. The dealer starts by discarding a tile.

4. The Flow of Play

Take turns playing counter-clockwise (East → South → West → North). Draw clockwise from the wall. Between turns you may claim a discarded tile instead of drawing to complete a meld by exposing it. End your turn by discarding a tile.

Core Concepts

What Is a Meld?

A **meld** is a legal set of tiles that counts toward your winning hand. In Hong Kong mahjong you typically need **four melds plus one pair**. Melds can stay hidden in your hand (concealed) or be laid face-up after you claim a discarded tile (exposed).

The Melds

Chi Sequence
Three tiles in a consecutive run of one suit (e.g. 2-3-4 Characters). Only claimable from the player on your left.

Pung Triplet
Three identical tiles. You may claim a matching discard from any player. Has priority over a chi.

Kong Quad
Four identical tiles. Claim a discard to make an exposed kong, or declare a concealed kong or add it to an exposed meld when you draw the fourth yourself. After either, draw a replacement tile from the end of the wall. Has priority over a pung.

Pair The Eyes
Two identical tiles that complete the hand. Every winning hand needs exactly one pair.

Winning on the Last Tile

You can win by **self-drawing** the last tile you need from the wall, or by **claiming** that tile from anyone's discard. A win has the highest priority over chi, pung, and kong. If more than one player needs the same discard to win, the next player in the turn order wins.

Concealed vs. Exposed

A hand is **concealed** if you never claim a discard tile (except the winning tile). Concealed hands and self-draws earn bonus faan. Claiming discards **exposes** those melds face-up on the table for everyone to see.

Flowers & Seasons

Eight **bonus tiles**. They never form melds and are not part of your hand. Set them aside when drawn and take a replacement tile from the end of the wall.

Plum

Orchid

Chrysanthemum

Bamboo

Spring

Summer

Autumn

Winter